



more than I should have, and for a moment, wondered if this mechanic would become annoying over time.

But as I progressed more in the game, things got easier. I started scanning enemies faster, planning my hacking path instinctively, and timing those shots more confidently. Suddenly, what felt overwhelming at first became engaging. Perhaps this is why I spent over 3 hours at one sitting when I initially planned on trying out the game for roughly 1 hour.

Moreover, the gunplay supports this combat style well. Weapons feel weighty, each shot carries impact, and there is a satisfying feedback loop when you hit exposed weak points. Then there are weapon cooldowns that add a small layer of strategy, forcing you to switch things up instead of relying on a single gun.

PERFORMANCE

On my main rig, the game ran at around 50-60 FPS with max graphics settings and path tracing enabled. Considering the fact that I was playing this on a custom-cooled PC equipped with a 5090 GPU, it is evident that the game is quite demanding.

Now, the moment I switched on DLSS 2x, it jumped to 120 FPS, and DLSS 4x pushed it well past 200 FPS. There were also no sudden frame drops, no weird stutters during combat, and nothing that pulled me out of the experience.

STORY AND CHARACTERS

Pragmata doesn't try to slowly pull you into its world. It throws you straight into action. In a few minutes, the game pairs you with a mysterious android child and expects you to fig-

ure things out while everything around you is falling apart. That mix of chaos and companionship is what makes it all so interesting.

You play as Hugh, a fairly standard action protagonist, and you are accompanied by Diana, an android child who handles the hacking side of things. Their relationship is at the centre of the story, and it is very obviously aiming for that emotional, protective dynamic. In fact, there are ample reels on Instagram calling this game a 'father simulator.'

And you can see the inspiration. It feels similar to what *Death Stranding* did with Sam and Lou. It comes close to establishing that emotional connection, but it still feels like a lot more could have been done.

Hugh feels like someone you have seen before. He is tough, quiet and capable, but not as memorable as you would want him to be. Diana is more interesting because she is directly tied to gameplay, but her emotional arc feels a bit rushed. The bond between them develops quickly, almost too quickly, without enough moments to make it feel earned.

Talking about the story, it starts slow, picks up pace and gets super interesting towards the climax. Yet, there seems to be a lot of potential that wasn't taken advantage of. There is a rogue AI, a failed lunar colony, massive 3D printing systems out of control and a lot more that could have been explained in depth.

You find pieces of it in logs and optional content, which is fine, but it often feels like the most interesting parts of the story are happening outside the main narrative. That disconnect makes it harder to stay invested.

The story of the game starts on a promising note, feels a bit fragmented in the middle, and reaches its full peak towards the climax. *

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